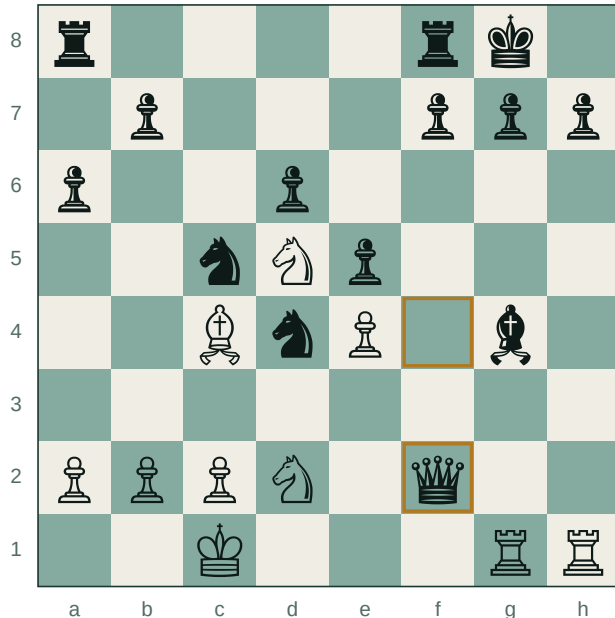


Anastasia mating nets: White, move 20

Anastasia mating nets

White to move



Previous move: 19...Qxf2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

20. Ne7+ Kh8 21. Rxh7+ Kxh7 22. Rh1+ Qh4 23. Rxh4+ Bh5 24. Rxh5#

20.Ne7+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **20...Kh8**.

21.Rxh7+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the pawn on h7. Recorded reply: **21...Kxh7**.

22.Rh1+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **22...Qh4**.

23.Rxh4+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From h4 it attacks king on h7 and bishop on g4. Recorded reply: **23...Bh5**.

24.Rxh5# Mate: rook on h5 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h7. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on h5. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The knight is often a supporting piece rather than the final checker. Do not overlook its quiet control of escape squares.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An Anastasia-type net uses a knight to restrict king escapes while a rook or queen checks along an edge file. Removing a pawn shield can be the crucial preparation.

HOW TO LOOK

Locate the knight's controlled flight squares and the heavy piece's checking line. Follow how the combination opens that line.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: bishop on g4 and queen on f2. Check for tactical protection.